

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: It's time to write a professional e-mail!



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a professional e-mail.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can discuss experiences I've had.

Ask your partner:

- How often do exchange e-mails in the workplace or in school?
- Do you use e-mails as an opportunity to build relationships? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Ferdinand is waiting for his **connection*** ... he gets an e-mail. Who is it from?

* A "connection" means to change from one flight to another in a city on the way to your final destination. You can also say *connecting flight*.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Subject: Arrangements for your trip and Farmani's new clothing line

Hi Ferdinand,

How are you? I hope you're well and you've had a good week. Have you visited the shops yet?

Anyway, back to work. I just wanted to let you know that Polygon's driver will pick you up at the airport at 9:00 a.m. and drop you off at the hotel at approximately 9:30 a.m. I also confirmed with Peter that he's booked a hotel downtown and made a reservation at your favorite Colombian restaurant - El Trompo.

By the way, Farmani has sent me the new designs for the clothing line. They look fabulous! Please find them attached to this e-mail. We can discuss them in depth when you've had a chance to look them over.

Looking forward to chatting with you. Have a good flight.

All the best,
Miranda

Subject: Thank you

Hi Miranda,

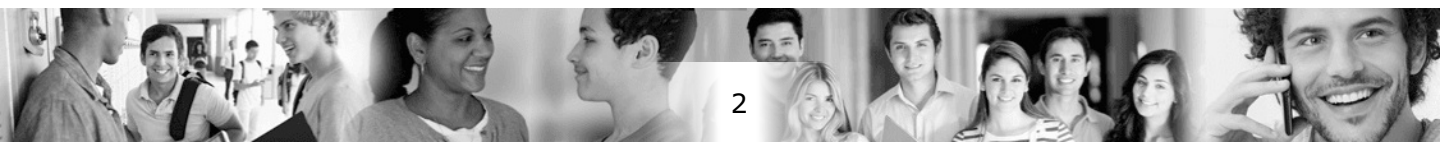
Thank you for your kind e-mail.

I hope you're enjoying fall in Boston. And I really hope you're not working too hard.

I appreciate you taking care of the last-minute details. I am still in Panama waiting for my connection to Colombia. By the way, I can't wait to have a real Colombian meal! I'm tired of eating frozen dinners so often!

Anyway, I will be happy to look over the designs. I know this trip will be very productive.

Thanks again for everything.
Ferdinand





Let's Practice!

What does Miranda write about to Ferdinand?

Instructions: Read the e-mail. Complete the sentences by selecting the correct option.

1. Subject: _____ **arrange / arrangements / arranging** for your trip and Farmani's new clothing line

_____ **Good morning / Hey you / Hi Ferdinand,**

How are you? I hope you're well and you've had a _____ **trip / great lunch / good week**. Have you visited the shops yet?

_____ **On the way / On that way / By the way**, Farmani has sent me the new _____ **book / details / designs** for the clothing line and they look fabulous! Please find them attached to this e-mail. We can discuss them _____ **in depth / en route / up there** when you've had a chance to _____ **run / look / see** them _____ **over / under / above**. Looking forward to _____ **chatting / chats / talk** with you. Have a good flight.

_____ **All the way / Best / Sincere,**

Miranda

2. Subject: Thank you

Hi Miranda,
Thank you for your kind e-mail.

I hope you're enjoying fall in Boston.

I appreciate you taking care of the _____ **up to the minute / last minute / last hour** details.

_____ **Anyone / Any day / Anyway**, I will be happy to look over the designs. I know this trip will be very _____ **in depth / careful / productive**.

Thanks again for everything.

Ferdinand



Let's Practice!

What has been arranged?

Instructions: Read the e-mails. Underline all the sentences in the Simple Past and Present Perfect tenses. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Subject: Arrangements for your trip and Farmani's new clothing line

Hi Ferdinand,

How are you? I hope you're well and you've had a good week. Have you visited the shops yet?

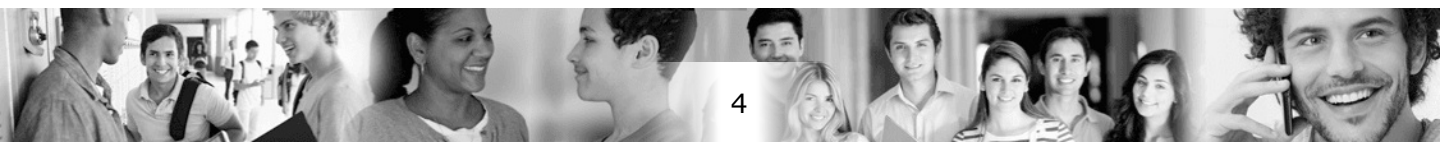
Anyway, back to work. I just wanted to let you know that Polygon's driver will pick you up at the airport at 9 am and drop you off at the hotel at approximately 9:30 am. I also confirmed with Peter that he's booked a hotel downtown and made a reservation at your favorite Colombian restaurant - El Trompo.

By the way, Farmani has sent me the new designs for the clothing line. They look fabulous! Please find them attached to this e-mail. We can discuss them in depth when you've had a chance to look them over.

Looking forward to chatting with you. Have a good flight.

All the best,

Miranda





Extension Activity

Can you write a professional e-mail.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write an e-mail to a business co-worker or partner.
- Start the mail with a friendly beginning.
- Show some interest and share important information.
- Switch the topic to a business matter.
- End the e-mail and sign off.
- When you are finished, read your partner's mail aloud.
- Answer your partner's mail with an appropriate mail reply.

Self-Assessment

Yes
No

I write a professional mail.

☐ ☐

I can switch topics in my e-mail.

☐ ☐

I can reply to a business e-mail.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **arrangements** (noun): practical plans for managing details for things or people
e.g. Peter has made arrangements for your trip.
- **in depth** (expression): very detailed, providing much information
e.g. We can discuss the new designs in depth.
- **to look over** (verb): to examine something, usually quickly
e.g. We can discuss them when you've had a chance to look them over.
- **last-minute** (adjective): done at the last possible moment
e.g. I appreciate you taking care of the last-minute details.
- **productive** (adjective): working hard and achieving good results
e.g. I know this trip will be very productive.



Learning Points

Maintaining Good Relationships

Communication is key when it comes to healthy relationships. When writing professional e-mails, it is important to use friendly language that will keep you and your co-workers on good terms. Here's some language you can use to:

1. Make a friendly start

- *Hi Leo,*
- *Morning Jonathan,*
- *Hello Mike,*
- *Mary,*
- *I hope you're well/I hope you're enjoying the nice weather.*
- *I hope you're having a good week.*

2. Follow up after a contact

- *Thank you for your kind e-mail.*
- *Thank you for your hospitality.*
- *It was good seeing you!*
- *It was great to see you yesterday.*

3. Show interest & share information

- *Hope you had a good trip/vacation/weekend/holiday.*
- *Hope you're not working too hard.*
- *How are things in Toronto/Colombia?*
- *I've just got back from a trip to South America and it was amazing!*

4. End the e-mail

- *Looking forward to seeing you/meeting you/hearing from you.*
- *Have a safe/good flight.*
- *Enjoy your stay/trip/conference.*

5. Sign off

- *Best wishes*
- *Best regards*
- *Best*
- *Thanks*
- *Thanks for everything*
- *Take care*





Learning Points

Past Simple and Present Perfect

When writing professional e-mails, you will often need to use the **Present Perfect** or the **Past Simple**. Here are some ways in which you can use them.

1. Use the **Past Simple** to talk about a completed action in the past. The time is usually obvious from the context.

I also confirmed a hotel downtown with Peter.

2. Use the **Past Simple** (with a present meaning) when you want to be more polite.

I just wanted to let you know that someone will pick you up at 9 am.

3. Use the **Present Perfect** to talk about a past action which has an effect in the present.

He's booked a hotel downtown for you and has made reservations at your favorite restaurant.

He's sent me the new clothing designs.

4. Use the **Present Perfect** to talk about an action we expected to be completed but hasn't been.

Have you packed your bags yet?

Let's talk about when you've had a chance to take a look at them.

